

Moonsea Rising - 20230813

Cadmus is a Dick

The people behind the bar appear to be a barkeep, and elderly beggar, a crying peasant woman, a commoner, and the waitress. None of them seem to be happy, possibly because they have nooses around their necks, run up to the rafters, and they seem to be standing on tiptoes, as well as being gagged.

Cadmus asks if they're like to surrender and admit to what he's been told about them overthrowing the Count. Harken says they should be able to do this without involving the smallfolk. Cadmus snaps his fingers, and Harken disappears. Lirael detects the echoes of fey magick having been cast beforehand. Cadmus asks if any of them wish to deny the allegations. Lirael and Taevyn both tell him he's clearly wrong. He takes a moment to denigrate both, and turns to Beitris, to accuse her more directly. She starts talking past him, slagging him off to Lennox. He claims her beloved horse is being roasted for food, but she doesn't take the bait.

The bearded man beside Cadmus backs up his claims as he represents the law in this moment. Taevyn begins towards the bar to cut down the bound captives, but Cadmus and his friend warn him off. Cadmus represents them as tried and convicted traitors, which Taevyn is unmoved by. Cadmus directs the mage to deal with the party.

The mage begins casting. Beitris cast shield, and gives Lennox heroism. The wizard creates a wall of air to slowly start pushing the prisoners off the bar. Lirael slings tendrils of sap at Cadmus, but fails at hitting him. He throws a dagger at Beitris, but misses, and ducks behind a table. Taevyn flourishes his rapier, drawing the mage's attention, and dives across the bar towards him, knocking one of the women causing her to put more weight on the rope. He tumbles behind the mage, and slams him with the guard on his rapier, hitting him heavily. Lennox sprints towards Cadmus, hitting him with his axe. Beitris summons a mace of spiritual energy which strikes at Cadmus, missing him across the table, and raises her shield again.

The mage flings a sphere of fire at Taevyn, who dives aside. He grabs the bartenders to hide behind. Lirael squats down, and a black bear rises up through her. She thunders across the room to the left in the bar. Whipping a pair of spiked manacles off his belt, Cadmus snaps them on Lennox's wrists, the spikes biting into his flesh.

Taevyn whips out his dagger and cuts the barkeep's hands free. He crams the dagger into his hands, yelling to him to cut himself down. Lennox struggles against the magical manacles, trying to break free. He slashes Cadmus with his axe, roaring in frustration. Beitris directs the spiritual weapon at Cadmus, but he dodges. She advances on him, raising her shield again. The mage laughs at Taevyn's attempts to save the barkeep, and pushes the flaming sphere at him again, though he dodges. He runs back along the bar, and pulls the nearest captive off the bar.

Lirael climbs atop the bar, and with two quick swipes cut down the woman who passed out and the man the mage pulled back. Cadmus slashes twice at Lennox, missing on the second cut, as the big man mocks him. Taevyn dives and dances through the commoners on the floor, getting

behind the mage. In the distance, a horse screams in agony. He runs the mage through with his rapier, and the wall of wind immediately ceases. Dropping her illusory form, an unknown hag is revealed. She is devoid of color, with taut skin and electricity crackles in her white hair.

Roaring loudly, Lennox struggles against his manacles, but cannot break their grip. Beitris slashes out with divine lance, running through Cadmus, and directs the mace to follow him, but misses. Lirael steps closer to the remaining commoners, cutting one down, and then biting at the hag, but missing on the latter.

Cadmus taunts Beitris, claiming familiarity with her "arcane tricks", and proceeds to continue to try and murder the bound Lennox. The point of his rapier appears through the big man's shoulder, and drawing back he stabs him through the throat. As the big man falls to the ground, he strides toward Lady Beitris. Taevyn leaps up on the bar, and cuts down the waitress, securing the last of the commoners. He whips the dagger at the hag, cutting her deeply. In the corner, Lennox's wounds weep as the man lies still.

Beitris tries to cast a spell against Cadmus' mind, but he shrugs it off, chuckling. She swings her mace, but the blow glances off her. Lirael bites the hag, and swipes at her twice, connecting with a claw as well. The hag summons a thunderhead within the tavern, and blasts Lirael singeing her fur badly. Cadmus then stabs Beitris, and retrieves another set of manacles from his pack. Taevyn drops behind the bar, tumbling through the air, and slashing at the hag. He yells at the commoners on the ground to flee the storm, which they all start doing. As Lirael dives out of the way of the storm, the hag directs a bolt at Taevyn, hitting him badly. Turning to Lirael, the space around her shifts and merges as her form is compressed down into that of a bunny. Turning tail, the rabbit flees from the building, hiding beneath the level of the deck outside.

Cadmus continues to taunt Beitris, suggesting he might go for some rabbit stew. Instead, he stabs Beitris repeatedly, the horrible beak on his weapon slashing her deeply. Tapping his feet, Taevyn grabs the hag in a whirling dance, spinning her and himself away from the stop. Flinging her aside, he stabs her repeatedly with his rapier, leaving her near death. Beitris heals herself, then directs a beam of holy energy into Lennox, as the man awakes with a jolt.

The hag fires a jet of water at Taevyn, slamming the young man backwards into the storm, where a bolt of lightning strikes him, blasting him down to the floor. Gathering herself outside, Lirael turns back into her bear form, crouched by the deck. Meanwhile, Cadmus manages to slap the manacles on Beitris' wrists. Behind him, Lennox manages to snap the manacles on his wrists, and. Stands. Up.

Beitris steps back from Cadmus, raising her shield. The hag flees across the room, and looses a lightning bolt at Lennox, which he turns away from. Suddenly, the blood loss gets to her, and she drops to the floor.

Roaring, Lirael smashes through the window, snapping and clawing at Cadmus, who dances away from her strikes. He ripostes with his rapier, and she drops hard to the floor. He moves to slash at Beitris, but her shield holds. Lennox shouts at Cadmus, "die, little man!" Rushing forward, he slashes at him with his axe, but misses. Beitris struggles against her bonds, but fails to free herself. She restores her shield, and shoves him, hard, off the table. As he falls, Lennox strikes him a glancing blow with his axe. Shaken, Cadmus springs to his feet, and slashes Lennox twice, dropping the big man again.

Beitris manages to wrench free of her manacles, and blasts Lennox with healing sunlight. As the hag's magic ebbs, Harken Betony reappears by the door of the room. Taking in the scene, he quickly strides behind Cadmus, slashing at him twice with his rapier.

Cadmus looks around. The fight, having gone decidedly to his disadvantage, he ducks away, and turns and flees the tavern. Lennox follows, slashing at him as he tries to mount his horse. Beitris focuses, and a corruscating rainbow of colors blasts throughout the room, healing everyone slights. Harken strides out of the room, drawing his bow and sends an arrow straight into Cadmus' back as he mounts. Lirael stands up, and jumps back through the window leveling a blast of searing light at Cadmus which misses him.

Cadmus finishes mounting the horse, and, as he whips it on, Lennox brings his axe around in a flat arc, decapitating him in one fell swoop. The horse flees as the man in black falls to the dirt of the road, in two almost simultaneous thumps.

Following the others outside, Beitris finds the remains of her beloved horse slain by the hitching post.

The barkeep and others crowd around the party, thanking them for saving them, wondering if they were still under sentence of death. Lirael tells them she doubts Cadmus' charges are known beyond those alive. She counsels that they do something with Cadmus' remains, lest this only get worse from here.